

ALERT-99: Best-Practice Summary and Setup Checklist

Series: ALERT — Alerting Strategy and Design | **Notebook:** 99 of 05 | **Created:** June 2026 | **Last Updated:** 06/16/2026

Overview

The series on one page: the principles, a complete end-to-end setup checklist, and the cross-series map of where each piece is built. Use this as the standing reference once you have read ALERT-01 through ALERT-04.

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Prerequisites

Requirement	Details
Prior reading	ALERT-01 through ALERT-04
Companion series	AIOPS, SLO, WFLOW, OPIPE

1. Principles

1. **OOTB Davis first.** Tune before you build; descend the funnel only when the layer above cannot express the condition.
2. **One enriched problem is the hub.** Every mechanism converges on a Davis problem; everything downstream operates on it.
3. **Enrich upstream or you cannot route downstream.** Team/zone/severity belong on the problem before a workflow ever sees it.
4. **Burn-rate beats threshold-on-SLI.** Alert on how fast the budget drains, with multiwindow confirmation.
5. **Prefer simple workflows.** Pay for multi-step only when you need conditional/multi-team logic.
6. **Match destination to urgency.** Fast-burn → page; slow-burn → ticket.
7. **Validate every query before it becomes an alert.** A detector on a silent query is worse than no alert.

2. Complete Setup Checklist

Detection

- [] Reviewed OOTB Davis anomaly detection settings and tuned sensitivity
- [] Custom anomaly detectors only where Davis does not cover the condition (auto-adaptive/seasonal, not static-on-traffic)
- [] Log/span signals extracted to OpenPipeline metrics before alerting on them
- [] SLOs defined for critical user journeys with burn-rate alerts

Enrichment

- [] Detector event templates carry team / zone / service properties
- [] Entity tags and Smartscape ownership populated for OOTB problems
- [] `event.severity` used to drive priority

Routing

- [] Problem-trigger workflows filter on enriched metadata
- [] Simple workflows used wherever conditional logic is not needed
- [] Fast-burn → page channel; slow-burn → ticket channel
- [] One notification per problem (no duplicate alerts on raw metrics)

ITSM / destinations

- [] ServiceNow incidents carry assignment group, priority, and a de-dup correlation

key

- [] Legacy alerting-profile integrations identified; migration to workflows considered

Governance

- [] Production detectors/SLOs promoted to config-as-code
- [] Alerts that fire without action reviewed and tuned

3. Cross-Series Map

Piece	Built in
Anomaly detector mechanics (analyzer, tuning, event template)	AIOPS-02
Metric events / detector schemas as code	AIOPS-02 §6, AUTOM-05/06
OpenPipeline metric extraction	OPIPE, FAQ-09
SLIs, error budgets, burn-rate alerting	SLO-02 / 03 / 04
SLOs as code	SLO-05
Routing, conditions, escalation	WFLOW-03 / 04
HTTP / webhook actions	WFLOW-08
ServiceNow incident integration	ALERT-04
Cost / DPS framing	FINOPS, FAQ-09

Sources: [Alerting and notifications \(DT docs\)](#), [Workflows \(DT docs\)](#). **Derived:** the checklist and funnel synthesise the ALERT, AIOPS, SLO, and WFLOW series into one operational sequence.

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